

MORE DETAILS OF PLAN OF INCOME TAX RETURN

It will require a small army of men to take the income tax returns of persons subject to the new law. Collector of Internal Revenue, Milton A. Miller, announced that fifteen officers will start from his headquarters on January 1 and on January 2 every one of them will be on the job at the points in the respective counties as designated, to meet the people and help them make out their income tax returns. The officer assigned to Clackamas county is due to arrive here on February 2, and to remain until February 23, both dates inclusive. He will have his office in the court house at the county seat, where he may be found every day of the dates stated.

"It will be well for every unmarried person whose net income for 1917 is \$1000, or over, and every married person living with wife or husband whose net income for 1917 is \$2000, or over, to call on the income tax man and learn whether or not they have any tax to pay," Collector Miller said. "The person subject to tax who doesn't make return in the time prescribed is going to regret it. The government will get after all income tax slackers."

"There's hardly a business man, merchant or professional man who won't have to make return of income. Farmers, as a class, will have to pay the tax. The safe thing to do is for every person who had a total income of \$1000, or \$2000, as the case may be, and who is not sure about what deductions the law allows him, to play it safe by calling on the income tax man."

"The man sent by the collector will have forms for everybody and persons who expect to call on him need not trouble themselves to write for forms."

GRAZING FEES

District Forester Says They Will Not Be Effective This Year

That the proposed increase in grazing fees on the national forests will not take effect the coming season, is the information furnished by District Forester Geo. H. Cecil, Portland, who is in receipt of a letter from the forester's office on the subject.

A study of the value of grazing privileges on lands within the different national forests has been made during the past summer by the department of agriculture which indicates that in general the fees charged in 1917 are still below the real value of the forage. However, many important changes have taken place due to the present war conditions, and stockmen have been called upon to overcome many difficulties in order to keep up the country's supply of beef, mutton, hides and wool, not only for our own use but also to help meet the needs of the allies. It is in view of this situation that the secretary has decided to defer action in connection with any further increase in grazing fees on the national forests for the present. The grazing fees now in force will be continued with the exception of such minor changes as may seem advisable to adjust and correlate the fees between certain forests or groups of forests.

The plan to issue five or ten-year permits which would not be subject to reduction during the period for which they are issued except for damage to the range or violation of their terms, will also be held in abeyance.

The demand for an increase in meat production and the necessity for stocking the forest ranges to the extreme limit of safety, makes the issuance of such permits inadvisable, according to Mr. Cecil, since with them in force forest officers would not be able to make certain readjustments and allotments which the present situation with reference to meat production may require.

With the exception of a possible slight adjustment on the Siskiyou forest in order to make the fees uniform on this forest and the Crater forest, the grazing fees to be charged on the national forests of district 6 during the season of 1918 will be the same as the fees charged for the season of 1917.

DULL AND SHARP SHOOTING PAINS

Michigan Lady Suffered Such Pains In Back and Head, But Says Cardui Stopped These Bad Spells.

Palmyra, Mich.—Mrs. Chas. T. Fuller, of this place, writes: "In 1911 I got run-down, and I suffered great pain...with both dull and sharp shooting pains...also back and head. I was weak and could only drag around, and should have been in bed. I really wasn't able to be up. At times I would have spells that would be so bad I'd have to go to bed, and suffered intensely..."

I decided to try Cardui, and saw a great improvement in less than a month's time. I used 7 or 8 bottles and was stronger...I got so much better that my strength returned and my work was easy for me. Cardui did me a world of good. It built me up in health and strength. I haven't had one of those bad spells since. I haven't had to take any more medicine since or have any doctors either and have been able to do my work right along...I recommend it to other women highly as the best medicine I know of for women who suffer from female trouble."

RELEASE THE FARMER

Activity in the East Leads to Training of Younger Men

An eastern farm adviser declared the other day that at least 1000 men must be released from the draft if his county is to produce anything like normal crops next year. Farms are being abandoned because of the inability of the farmers to secure help. Not only is farm labor being drawn away by the draft, but in many sections it is lured away by the offer of higher wages in the munitions factories and other wartime industries.

If necessity drove the nation to this sacrifice something could be said for it. But, as Lieutenant General Young and other high military authorities have shown the president and congress, the method is both unnecessary and militarily unsound. Instead of drawing away skilled workers in wartime industries, taking them from highly productive service and putting them in training where they not only cease to be productive, but become for a long period a positive burden on the country, we should start immediately the training of 2,000,000 available youths of the ages of 19, 20 and 21 years, now exempt from call under the present draft law.

There are about 3,000,000 young men in these three classes, and military authorities estimate that nearly 2,000,000 of them could pass the physical, mental and moral examination. As a class they are without dependent obligations, and where employed in business or industry hold places of slight responsibility. They are at the athletic period of life, and the period when military training is most readily taken.

It is not proposed that any of these youths shall be put on the firing line before they are 21, but that their necessary training shall be started now, so that they will be ready for service at 21 or 22.

This is one of the most important acts of legislation now before congress concerning the farmer, the manufacturer and the whole nation as well. For unless provision is made to put these younger men under the draft, the tendency will constantly increase to take older skilled labor and married men from the factories and the farms.

The reasons for the proposed amendment were stated in a few words by Secretary of War Baker the other day:

"I have believed all along," said Mr. Baker, "that boys of 19 at least should be subject to draft. At that age they are physically developed enough to make good soldiers and they have not assumed any of those responsibilities which made the drafting of older men a disturbance economically throughout the nation."

The civil war was fought by youths under 21. We are drafting our armies now from men ranging from 21 to 30, and taking volunteers of yet older ages. The country ran to one extreme in the civil war, an extreme The Farmer would not for a moment approve; but it is apparent that we are swinging now to another extreme that threatens the productive powers of the nation, and which, if continued, might lose the war.

PLATINUM IS FAKE

Geological Survey Finds Shortage Little Helped in Oregon

The present shortage of platinum and the consequent greatly increased price of the metal bid fair to result in a considerable increase in the domestic production of platinum during the coming year. At the same time, while legitimate miners are increasing their production and to some extent relieving the country's shortage, other persons are using the interest aroused by the present nationwide search for the metal to make extravagant claims for utterly worthless deposits, and some honest prospectors are led by false assays, made by inefficient or venal assayers, to believe mistakenly that they have valuable platinum deposits. Reports of platinum in some mythical combination—"volatile platinum" or "colloidal platinum"—should be regarded as sufficient evidence of the incompetence or dishonesty of the assayer.

During the season of 1917 the geologists of the United States Geological Survey, department of the interior, spent much time in visiting platinum deposits that proved to be worthless. A notable example is seen in the supposed platiniferous sands of the Deschutes river, near Terrebonne, Ore., which were examined by Mr. H. G. Ferguson in October, 1917. Claims have been staked for several miles along Deschutes and Crooked rivers, and as certain volcanic sands along these rivers had been said to contain large percentages of gold and rare metals, particularly metals of the platinum group, Mr. Ferguson visited the localities at which the sands were obtained and took samples for test and analysis.

The material collected, which is exposed in the canyon of the Deschutes river north of Low Bridge in sec. 15, T. 14, S., R. 12 E., consists of loosely cemented dark volcanic sand and conglomerate interbedded with basalt and volcanic tuff. The black basaltic sand is supposed to have the richest content of gold and platinum, but neither in panning the material in the field nor in the chemical tests made by the geological survey could any trace of platinum or other metals of the platinum group be found in the concentrates, and it is concluded that material of this type is very unlikely to contain workable amounts of gold.

In conclusion, the geological survey desires to warn prospectors and investors against accepting at their face value any statements in regard to platinum-bearing ores and sands that do not show native platinum when panned. Such material should always be sent to assayers whose reputation is above reproach.

TO STORE VEGETABLES

Outdoor Cellar or Cave Is Considered Best Place.

House Is Too Warm and Atmosphere Too Dry—Three Important Factors Are Ventilation, Temperature and Moisture.

"All things considered, an outdoor cellar or cave is the best place to store your vegetables for winter," says a writer in an exchange. "An ordinary house cellar is, as a rule, too warm and the atmosphere too dry for most vegetables. Sweet potatoes and squash would keep well in such a place, but that is about all. A pit is also a very good place to keep most vegetables, but is rather inconvenient. There are three things to consider when storing vegetables for winter use; they are the temperature, ventilation and the moisture. They are very important. Always keep them in mind. You will either succeed or fail by the correct or improper management of these three things. The germs which are the cause of decay like a high temperature, and most of them like a poorly ventilated place."

"With this in mind, the logical thing to do, it would seem, would be to keep the pit or cave where you are storing your vegetables dry and as cool as possible. This, however, you cannot always do, as some vegetables must have moisture to preserve their plumpness and quality, while others must have heat in order to keep well. Fortunately, it seems the vegetables that require the moisture can be stored at a very low temperature, and those that must have heat can be kept in a dry place. Beets, cabbage, carrots, parsnips, potatoes, salsify and turnips require more or less moisture, but should be kept at a temperature as near freezing as possible and yet not freeze. Squash and sweet potatoes like a warm, dry atmosphere. Keep the temperature as near 50 or 60 degrees as possible. Onions must be kept at about 33 or 34 degrees and in a dry place."

MARKET ALL SLACKER FOWLS

It Does Not Pay to Feed High-Priced Corn to Laying Hens—Sell All Nonproducers.

(Ohio Agricultural College Bulletin.) Now is the time for every hen to proclaim whether she is doing her bit or is a slacker. It will not pay to feed five-cent corn to laying hens. Many of the old hens should be sold within the next few weeks. They will be nonproducers and expensive feeders. Breeding from them will produce poor pullets.

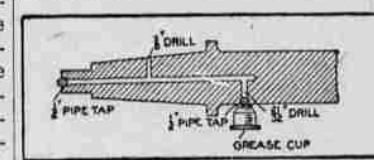
Hens that should go to market are: (1) Those with bright colored legs; (2) those with combs that are mottled, dry, hard and rough to the touch; (3) those that are molting early.

The good hens exhibit the following characteristics: (1) The combs are of good size, and are soft and pliable. (2) The shanks are pale due to the fact that the pigment is drawn out of the legs during egg production. (3) No signs of molting were shown up to September 15.

GREASING WHEELS OF WAGON

Contributor to Popular Mechanics Magazine Gives Illustration and Description of Good Method.

Drill a hole, two-third-one-half inch in diameter, in the center of each axle and connect it with a hole of the same size just back of the shoulder on the spindle and on the under side of the



Cup Attached to Spindle.

axle. This is the right size hole to tap for one-half inch fittings, writes W. E. Crane of Cleveland, Ohio, in Popular Mechanics Magazine. The center of the spindle is drilled with a three-eighths inch drill to make a hole intersecting the horizontal one. A one-half inch plug is turned into the end of the hole, and a grease cup fitted on the under side, as shown. In greasing the wheel, turn the cup down sufficient to force the grease into the axle.

SCARE SHEEP-KILLING DOG

Dummy of Man Holding Stick or Gun Will Frighten Curs Away—Keep Moving It About.

A Minnesota farmer writes that he keeps dogs away from his flock by putting up in his pasture the dummy of a man holding a stick or a gun. This dummy is taken down every morning and put up again in the evening at different places, from night to night. He says a sheep-killing dog will not go near enough to the dummy to discover that he is a bogus man.

DIFFERENT TYPES OF PLOWS

Before Purchasing Farmer Should Consider Construction of Harrows and Packers.

Different types of land require particular kinds of plows, and there is a difference in the construction and quality of harrows and packers which every farmer should consider before purchasing a supply of these tools.

Appeal From Justice Court

A transcript of appeal from the court of Justice DeVore at Estacada, has been filed in the circuit court here in the case of William Stubbs vs. Arthur Scott. Mr. Stubbs secured a verdict for \$50 in the justice court to cover alleged unpaid rent. He asks \$75 as damages and this the justice court jury did not award him. Hence the appeal to the circuit court.

The Oregon City Courier and the Oregon Farmer both for \$1.00 for one year.

PENNIES BUY BADGE

Hazelia, a community near Oswego, Friday had a practical demonstration of youthful patriotism when Kenneth Baker an 8-year-old lad, visited the Red Cross headquarters there and, with 100 pennies, bought a membership in the society. The little fellow had been saving his pennies for several months and when he marched up to the Red Cross booth Friday he said: "I have two brothers in the war and I want one of those Red Cross badges." The lad's brothers are in the aviation service.

CHRISTMAS WAS BRIGHT

FOR OUR BOYS IN FRANCE

Some of Oregon City's boys in France, especially those in company F, 18th railway engineers, have had great times this Christmas. There are a number of local young men in company F, of which Kenneth D. Hauser of Portland is captain. In a letter to his father, Eric V. Hauser, of Portland, the captain says:

Today we received twenty-eight sacks of mail for company F, marked "Kenneth D. Hauser." It filled the whole regimental postoffice and was the envy of the camp. I decided to issue the articles to the boys who needed them, so we got busy and dolled them out. Our orderly room is in one of the huts, and as the line in we had it all systematized. First, I had the articles checked over and totaled on paper, then we divided them into the number of men—men and officers—share and share alike. They made a sample test of what each man's share was. One man took charge of each article, and we would call a man's name and the article. The man would hold a box and the things were thrown into it from all corners of the room. The line lasted three hours and it was better than a vaudeville show. It was so rich I went up to headquarters and invited all the officers down to see it and they all came.

Afterwards I got one of the boys from Port Angeles—Larry Mason—with his tenor and his guitar, and John Shaver with his ukelele, and our wonderful quartette—Jimmy Clock, Killyay Green of Aberdeen, Cecil McNutt of Port Angeles, and Cecil of Coos Bay—and we all sang the old songs and cheered the auxiliary. I declared "No Taps," and it is after midnight now and we have just quit. The officers all stayed to the finish and said my boys were wonderful—so close together and so talented and jolly.

Tell the auxiliary what a wonderful feeling of gratitude there is toward them. The football suits from Portland all arrived, and we are making use of them almost daily.

SECRETARY LANE TALKS OF WAR IN STATEMENT

Included in the recent annual report of Secretary Franklin K. Lane, is the following:

"When the bureau of mines was created by congress five years ago it was hardly to have been imagined that the methods used for the saving of life in the coal mines of the United States would become of vital use in the problem of saving lives and destroying lives in a world war; yet this is just what has happened. The soldier's kit, which was so simple a thing in other wars, has had to be increased by a gas mask not unlike the helmet of a deep-sea diver, with a box of chemicals adapted for offsetting the effects of the various kinds of gas the enemy is known to use."

"When we came into the war we found ourselves prepared with the knowledge, the machinery, and the men to promptly meet the need of gas masks in great quantity and of a superior type. This the men who had been in this work of meeting the gases compounded in nature's laboratory were found to have a reserve of knowledge as to what gases will kill and what will choke and what will burn and what will hasten disease, which in a war of cumulative frightfulness would make the United States modestly distinguished if it wished to so shine. As one of the group said:

"We chemists in America have never turned our minds to the destruction of human life. Our work has been constructive—the chemistry of the soil, of cement, of printer's ink, of the by-products from petroleum and tar, of 10,000 things which will make for a longer, a happier life for man. But if the world is to be turned upside down and instead of staying death and disease and making new things that man can use for his own enlightenment we are wanted to push forward the work of the destruction of man and all his works we can become rivals of the worst in such enterprise."

"This is not the time to present the things done and the things doing by these men of the necromantic science, but when the day comes for casting up accounts and giving credit their work will not go unrecognized."

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WATER SUPPLY SHUT OFF SUDDENLY SUNDAY NIGHT

Monday was not wash day in hundreds of Oregon City homes which have known Monday as the day of heated occupation over steaming washbasins for many years. There were not many faces washed in the city on the same day and there were only a few throats whose thirst was quenched. All because of the severe rain storms that raged during the last week. Without warning to users the city water board Sunday night suddenly shut off the water supply from the new 5,000,000-gallon reservoir and with the exception of a short time Monday there was not a drop of water in the pipes. At noon the water was turned on for about an hour.

When the board had the South Fork intake repaired and cleared of debris that had accumulated there during the storm, there was discovered a break in the main pipe line that had been concealed by the high water. In the meantime the users were taking the reservoir supply down rapidly until Monday morning there was estimated to be only a 24-hour supply in the great tank. The break in the main occurred in the vicinity of Clear creek, about 12 miles from the city, and far beyond the reservoirs. The smaller reservoir was emptied during the early days of the storm and there was thought to be a 12-day supply in the larger tank. This, however, had been so reduced that the board had to take sudden emergency measures to retain a supply of water for possible fire purposes. Pipe and workmen were on the ground as soon as possible and a temporary six-inch pipe was laid to take the place of the broken pipe for a distance of about 35 feet.

Those who did not get up before 7 o'clock Monday morning had no breakfast water, for the pipes were opened between 6:30 and 7.

PLAN TO DO AWAY WITH WASTE IS COMMUNICATED

In a communication to the state public service commission, John J. Seid, traffic manager of the Crown-Willamette Paper company, suggests that the car conservation movement can be aided materially if the movement of commodities from outside points of production to points where such commodities are already produced be discontinued, and also if movements to points of consumption be made from the nearest point of production. The suggestion, he declared, may be carried out either voluntarily by manufacturers or else prescribed by the federal authorities and the various state commissions regulating public utilities.

"The manufacturers of the Pacific coast have sufficient output to adequately care for Pacific coast consumption of these products," says the letter in referring to news print, paper, wrapping paper, tissue paper, and paper bags. "At the present time the manufacturers in the middle west and eastern states are shipping these productions to the Pacific coast and in turn the Pacific coast manufacturers are shipping to the middle western and eastern points of consumption."

"It is this company's intention to devote its facilities to supplying the Pacific coast market needs first, shipping to points other than the Pacific coast after Pacific coast needs have been cared for, and it is our understanding that other Pacific coast manufacturers of paper and paper products are in accord with this principle. We believe that the manufacturers should be requested to confine their shipments to contiguous territory, so long as the manufacturers in their respective territories can reasonably supply the demands made upon them. A liberal compliance with the plans above outlined should aid materially in increasing the number of cars available, relieve congestion on railroads by shortening the haul, eliminating excessive use of motive power and terminals and effect other economies."

The Lonesome Soldier

The Post Office department is telling of a man at a cantonment regarding whom that story was circulated that he was lonesome and had never received a letter since arrival in camp. Then came the deluge. In one mail he received 1,200 letters, 19 special delivery letters and parcels, and 54 ordinary parcels. Investigation showed that he could neither read nor write. He was found surrounded by several other soldiers who were helping him with his mail.

If you are up-to-date on the news of your home county you read The Courier.

TELLS MRS. HUGHES HOW Y. M. C. A. WORKS IN CAMP

Oregon City, Ore. Dec. 23, 1917. To the Courier: I am sending you a letter in regard to the work of the Y. M. C. A. in the camps. Mr. Finch is a former tester of the Clackamas County Cow Testing association, and is now at Camp Lewis. This letter is in reply to an inquiry in regard to the work of the Y. M. C. A. in the camps and covers the subject so well that I thought you would like to publish it.

MRS. A. E. HUGHES.

Camp Lewis, Wash. Nov. 19, '17. Mrs. A. I. Hughes: I will write you a letter describing the work of the Y. M. C. A. in the camp here. There are six Y. M. C. A. buildings scattered throughout the camp. The Y. M. C. A.'s here are the nearest thing to home. I can vouch for all the boys. We can spend our leisure time there, a place to go for amusements. Each Y. M. C. A. building is equipped with a piano and a phonograph.

Two evenings are spent each week for the boys to gather to sing songs. Moving picture shows are held twice a week, and on the other nights special programs are provided. One part of the Y. M. C. A. building is divided off for a reading room. In this room are found all the newspapers of the boys' home town, all the current magazines, and a bundle of magazines on hand to take to the barracks to read. Along the wall is to be found a book case; in this book case are to be found books for all different classes of boys. These books can be checked out and taken to the barracks to read.

On Sundays Bible services are held in each of the Y. M. C. A. buildings and song services held Sunday afternoons. Writing tables are provided at the pointies in the respective camps for the boys to write to friends and home.

I do not know what the boys would do that come to camp homesick, if they did not have a place to go to relieve their minds; or what we would do if we did not have a place to go to evenings to spend our leisure time, but to lie around on our beds until time for the lights to go out. Soldiering would be a very lonesome life. It is the greatest influence for good to be found in the army. Very truly, A. W. FINCH.

NEW COMMISSION NAMED Will Investigate Creamery Conditions Under Cooperation

Governor Withycombe has announced the appointment of C. C. Chapman, William Albers and W. D. B. Dodson, of Portland, as a commission to investigate creamery conditions in the state. Food Commissioner Mickle and W. K. Newell will co-operate with them in the making of the investigation. The last two were named at a meeting of creamery men recently in Portland. Some time ago the governor named as members of such a commission T. S. Townsend and E. L. Thompson, of Portland, and F. G. Dekebach, of Salem. For various reasons these men found themselves unable to serve, and hence the new commission.

Good To Have in the House

Coughs, colds, croup and lagrippe are prevalent. Colds promptly checked mean saving of time, money and health. Pneumonia and other serious illness may follow a neglected cold. T. F. Lynch, 100 Spring Ave., DuBois, Pa., writes: "For many years we have kept Foley's Honey and Tar in the house and it has saved many dollars in doctors' bills. It is fine for colds." A child's health is too precious to risk giving imitations or substitutes; insist on Foley's—Jones Drug Co.

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